

DANIEL SANTIAGO

Northampton, PA | (570) 801-8672 | danny9635@live.com

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cybersecurity professional with a B.S. in Cybersecurity, Data Analytics concentration, 3.91 GPA, Summa Cum Laude with 10+ years of enterprise-scale operations experience. Hands-on experience applying IAM principles and managing access controls across Active Directory, Okta, Azure AD, and Google Cloud environments. CompTIA Security+ certified with working knowledge of NIST CSF, CIS Controls, CIS Benchmarks, ISO 27001, MITRE ATT&CK, and Zero Trust architecture.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Cybersecurity-Focused Operations Professional | Walmart — Bethlehem, PA 2014 – Present

Multiple progressive roles with increasing security and systems responsibility:

Continuous Skills & Development Leader

Apr 2023 – Present

- Architected and enforced a 3-tier access control standard requiring testing, practical validation, and formal certification before granting production environment access — reducing unauthorized access risk across 500+ operational roles.
- Led enterprise system migration from Grocery Logistics System (GLS) to End Game as security SME, coordinating change-management approval workflows with legal, IT, and operational leadership to ensure zero data integrity incidents during cutover.
- Authored 20+ network-wide operational security procedures (AWIs) through structured multi-stakeholder change-management processes, establishing repeatable governance documentation aligned to NIST CSF principles.
- Designed role-based technical training matrices and cross-functional development programs that reduced facility turnover from 117% to under 10%, reducing operational access risk associated with high-turnover workforce environments.

Systems Operator

Jan 2016 – Present

- Led incident triage for enterprise-level 'War Room' events affecting access, system availability, and operational continuity for 1,000+ users — partnering with engineering teams to reduce mean time to resolution (MTTR) and document root-cause findings.
- Migrated manual user provisioning for 300+ operational roles to Active Directory group-based access controls, enforcing RBAC and least-privilege principles — eliminating over-provisioning and reducing the lateral movement attack surface.
- Hardened 200+ enterprise endpoints by restricting local administrative privileges and limiting web access to approved corporate applications, reducing exploit exposure across operational systems.
- Conducted quarterly Supply Chain Security audits across operational areas, identifying physical security gaps, documenting findings, and supporting compliance remediation efforts aligned to internal control frameworks.
- Developed operational security dashboards and audit reports from DRAX database metrics, enabling leadership visibility into access compliance, anomaly trends, and incident tracking.

Operations Leadership | Area Manager / Shipping Lead

Jan 2014 – Mar 2023

- Managed logistics operations and enforced 2-hour SLA compliance for teams of 30+ associates while maintaining DOT and hazardous materials regulatory compliance through standardized SOPs and regular audits.
- Served as primary escalation contact for high-priority operational disruptions, coordinating cross-functional resolution with corporate leadership — developing incident communication skills directly transferable to security operations.
- Led Kaizen-driven process improvement initiatives that doubled operational throughput (200 to 400 units/shift), demonstrating structured problem-solving and change management capabilities.

TECHNICAL PROJECTS | CLOUD, IAM & SECURITY

Security Findings Translator | Open Source Tool — Python, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, Docker | [Link](#)

- Built a full-stack security tool that parses AWS GuardDuty, Security Hub, and Nessus findings and uses AI to translate them into audience-specific language for 7 stakeholder types — executives, developers, security analysts, SOC teams, managers, DevSecOps, and GRC.
- Engineered a composite risk scoring engine combining CVSS, EPSS (real-world exploitation probability), and CISA KEV (confirmed active exploitation) — identifying and fixing a scoring bug where Log4Shell (CVSS 10.0, 100% EPSS) was incorrectly rated Medium due to an environment multiplier discounting active KEV signals
- Implemented OWASP Top 10 security hardening including bcrypt password hashing, JWT authentication, rate limiting, timing-attack-safe login, project-level access control, file upload validation, and non-root Docker containerization
- Deployed full backend with FastAPI async API, PostgreSQL database, Redis caching, nginx reverse proxy, and a single-page vanilla JavaScript frontend — all orchestrated with Docker Compose
- Achieved 32/32 passing unit tests with zero known CVEs across all dependencies (pip-audit clean)

Healthcare Facility Security Assessment & Risk Mitigation

- Performed a comprehensive security assessment of a simulated healthcare environment, identifying vulnerabilities impacting ePHI protection and prioritizing remediation using CVSS-based risk scoring aligned to HIPAA and NIST CSF requirements.
- Designed a VLAN-based network segmentation model separating guest traffic from sensitive clinical systems, reducing the potential blast radius of a network intrusion by isolating critical assets.

Cloud Security Breach Response | Cymbal Bank (GCP) — Security Analyst Role | [Link](#)

- Investigated a simulated enterprise cloud breach in Google Cloud Platform, containing the incident by isolating compromised VMs, revoking overprivileged public access, and restoring production systems from verified snapshots.
- Engineered an enterprise IAM framework using RBAC, MFA, and SSO integrating Okta and Azure AD to automate full user lifecycle governance — from onboarding provisioning to offboarding de-provisioning and access certification.
- Evaluated cloud configuration risks using security best practices aligned with CIS Benchmarks and NIST security principles.

Hands-On Cybersecurity Labs | TryHackMe

Top 5% of 7 million users worldwide

- Completed 100+ labs covering network scanning, enumeration, vulnerability analysis, and web application security testing using Kali Linux, Nmap, Gobuster, and Burp Suite across OWASP Top 10 scenarios.
- Practiced exploitation and privilege escalation techniques in controlled environments using Metasploit and Linux-based tooling, building attacker-mindset understanding applicable to defensive security roles.

National Cyber League (NCL) | Cybersecurity Competitor

- Applied vulnerability analysis, cryptography, log analysis, and traffic analysis techniques under time pressure in competitive cybersecurity challenges — placing competitively among peers in individual and team events.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Security & Governance: IAM, RBAC, MFA, SSO, Zero Trust, NIST CSF, ISO 27001, MITRE ATT&CK, CVSS, Vulnerability Management, Incident Response, Threat Intelligence, SIEM, Audit Support

Cloud & Identity: Okta, Azure AD, Active Directory, Google Cloud Platform, AWS GuardDuty, AWS Security Hub, Google Cloud Security, System Hardening, Cloud IAM

Tools & Technologies: FastAPI, Docker, Redis, Gemini AI, Kali Linux, Burp Suite, Nmap, Metasploit, Wireshark, Gobuster, Jira, ServiceNow, GitHub, Bash, Python, PowerShell, Excel

Frameworks & Operations: Agile/Scrum, HIPAA, NIST CSF, SOP Documentation, Change Management, Risk Assessment, Stakeholder Communication, Process Improvement

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Cybersecurity

Graduated 2026

Southern New Hampshire University, Manchester, NH | Concentration: Data Analytics

GPA: 3.91 | Summa Cum Laude | National Society for Leadership and Success

CERTIFICATIONS

CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) 2026

Google Cloud Security Professional Certificate 2025

Microsoft SC-500 Cloud and AI Security Engineer Associate Certification – In Progress Expected Q4 2026

PMI Risk Management Professional (PMI-RMP) — Coursework Completed 2025

Palo Alto Networks Cybersecurity Professional Certificate 2025

CONFERENCES & EVENTS

BSides Harrisburg — Security Conference Attendee

2026

Connected with BSides Harrisburg and Philadelphia BSides founders; building active presence in the regional security community

Cloud Security Alliance (CSA) Lehigh Valley Chapter — Meetup Attendee

2026

COMMUNITY INVOLVEMENT

Cloud Security Alliance (CSA) — Lehigh Valley Chapter | Member

- Engage with cloud security professionals through chapter events and educational sessions focused on cloud governance, emerging threats, Zero Trust, and AI security.